(a) Sohgaura Copper-plate
(b) Rummindei pillar-edict of Ashoka
(c) Prayaga-Prasasti
(d) Mehrauli Pillar inscription of Chandra

Ans. (a) : The earliest known copper-plate called Sohgaura is a Maurya record that mentions famine relief efforts. It is one of the very few pre-Ashoka Brahmi inscriptions in India.

7. The concept of Eight-fold path forms the theme of:
(a) Dipavamsa
(b) Divyavadana
(c) Mahaparinibban Sutta
(d) Dharma Chakara Pravartana Sutta

Ans. (d) : The Noble Eight fold Path, is one of the principal teachings of the Buddha, who described it as the way leading to the cessation of suffering (Dukkha) and attainment of self-awakening. In Buddhist symbolism, the Noble Eight fold Path is often represented by means of the Dharma wheel (Dharmachakra), whose eight spokes represent the eight elements of the path. Eight fold path includes right understanding, right speech, right livelihood; right mindfulness, right thought, right action, right effort and right concentration.

8. The given map relates to:



(a) Kanishka at the time of his death
(b) Samudra Gupta after the close of his south India compaigan
(c) Asoka towards close of his reign
(d) Empire to Thaneswar on the eve of Harsha's accessin

Ans. (c) : The given map is related to the reign of Ashoka towards end of his rule. Ashoka 304 - 232 BC popularly known as Ashoka the Great was an Indian emperor of the Maurya Dynasty who ruled over the Indian Sub continent from 269 BC to 232 BC. His empire stretched from present day Pakistan, Afghanistan in the west to the present-day Bangladesh and the Indian state of Assam in the east and as far South as Northen Kerala and Andhra.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

9. The loss of Qandhar was a big blow to the Mughal Empire from the view point of:
(a) Natural resource
(b) Buffer territory
(c) Communication
(d) Strategic stronghold

Ans. (d) : Shah Jahan recovered Kandhar in 1638 from the Iranians but lost it again in 1649 despite three campaigns. The loss of Kandhar was a big blow as it was a strategic stronghold.

10. Fawazil in the Sultanate period meant:
(a) Extra payment made to the nobles
(b) Revenue assigned in lieu of salary
(c) Excess amount paid to the exchequer by the iqtadars
(d) Illegal exactions extracted from the peasants

Ans. (c) : From the time of Balban the iqtadars were expected to send the excess of the income to the center after meeting his and the army's expenses this was known as Fawazil. It was done to maintain a balance between the income and expenditure of Iqta-holders.

11. The Sultan of Delhi who is reputed to have built the biggest network of canals in India was:
(a) Iltutmish
(b) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
(c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
(d) Sikandar Lodi

Ans. (c) : The Sultan of Delhi who is reputed to have built the biggest network of canals in India was Firoz Shah Tughlaq.

12. Consider the following statements:
Ahadis were those troopers who
1. Offered their services singly.
2. Did not attach themselves to any chief.
3. Had the emperor as their immediate conlonel
4. Attached themselves to Mirzas.
Of these statements:
(a) 1, 3 and 4 are correct
(b) 1, 2 and 3 are correct
(c) 2 and 3 are correct
(d) 1 and 4 are correct

Ans. (b) : Ahadis were the gentlemen troopers who were recruited individually and were under the command of a separate mansabdar or officer, and had a diwan and a bakhshi of their own. Ahadis were considered very efficient and loyal troops and were paid high salaries.

13. Consider the following:
1. Tughlaquabad fort **2. Lodi garden**
3. Qutb Minar **4. Fatehpur Sikri**
The correct chronological order in which they were built is:
(a) 3, 1, 4, 2 (b) 3, 1, 2, 4
(c) 1, 3, 2, 4 (d) 1, 3, 4, 2

Ans. (b) : Tughlaqabad fort - built by Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq - in 1321
Lodhi garden - built by Ala-ud-din Alam Shah - in 1444
Qutub Minar - construction started by Qutu-ud-din Aibak and completed by Iltutmish - 1192
Fatehpur Sikri - founded by Akbar - in 1569.

14. In the given map, the shaded part represents Akbar's empire at a certain juncture; A stands for an independent country and 'B' marks the site of a city. Which one of the following alternatives gives all correct information?



(a) Akbar in 1557 : (A) Golkunda, (B) Lahore
(b) Akbar in 1557 : (A) Khandesh, (B) Multan
(c) Akbar in 1605 : (A) Gondwana, (B) Multan
(d) Akbar in 1605 : (A) Gondwana, (B) Lahore

Ans. (d) : The shaded part represents Akbar's territory at the time of his death in 1605. A – Gondwana; B – Lahore

MODERN HISTORY

15. The member of Shivaji's Ashta Pradhana who looked after foreign affairs was
(a) Peshwa (b) Sachiv
(c) Pandit Rao (d) Sumant

Ans. (d) : There was a Council of Ministers consisting of eight ministers to advise the Maratha ruler Shivaji. This council was called 'Ashta Pradhan'. The foreign minister of this council who oversees foreign affairs was called Sumant or Dabir. The main work of Sumant or Dabir was to advise the king in respect of foreign states and in all matters of war and peace.

16. What is the correct sequence of the following events?
1. Tilak's Home Rule League
2. Kamagatamaru Incident
3. Mahatma Gandhi's arrival in India
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1, 2, 3 (b) 3, 2, 1
(c) 2, 1, 3 (d) 2, 3, 1

Ans. (d) : Tilak's Home Rule League – April, 1916; Karnagatamaru Incident – September, 1914; Mahatma Gandhi's arrival in India from South Africa –1915

17. Simon Commission of 1927 was boycotted because:
(a) There was no Indian Member in the Commission
(b) It supported the Muslim League
(c) Congress felt that the people of India are entitled to Swaraj
(d) There were differences among the members

Ans. (a) : In 1928, Simon commission came to India to look after the working of the govt. of India Act, 1919 and to suggest changes. But it consisted only of Englishmen & did not have a single Indian representative. That's why it received Pan India boycott.

18. The Indian Muslims, in general, were not attracted to the Extremist movement because of the:
(a) Influence of Sir Sayyid Ahmed Khan
(b) Anti-Muslim attitude of extremist leaders
(c) Indifference shown to Muslim aspirations
(d) Extremists policy of harping on Hindu past

Ans. (d) : In general, the Indian Muslims were not attracted to the extremist movement because of the religious policy of harping on Hindu past like celebrating Shivaji Jayanti and Ganesh Utsav by Tilak and holy dip in sacred rivers during Swadeshi movement.

19. Which one of the following events, was characterised by Montague as 'preventive Murder'?
(a) Killing of INA activists
(b) Massacre of Jallianwala Bagh
(c) Shooting of the Mahatma
(d) Shooting of curzon-wylhe

Ans. (b) : Jalianwala Bagh massacre of 13th April, 1919 was carried out by Reginald Edward Harry Dyer. Edwin Montague condemned the act and called it a ''Preventive Murder''. Whereas C.F. Andrews called it a ''ruthless murder''.